VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

The Second World War

Lecture-02

By – Kunal Sir



Topics *to be covered*

1. Consequences
2. Pearl Harbour Attack
3. Hiroshima Bombing



The Second World War

Causes (Dissatisfaction with the Treaty of Versailles, Rise of Fascism and Nazism, Policy of Appeasement, Japanese invasion of China, Failure of League of Nations and Hitler's invasion of Poland). Brief mention of the attack on Pearl Harbour and bombing of Hiroshima and Nagasaki. Consequences (Defeat of Axis Powers, Formation of the United Nations and Cold War).

(d) United Nations

Diwali Hardik ShubhKamnaye ..Hui..Hui...



Ladai To Balak Kiya Kare Hai...
Hum To World War Karte Hai...Mitr



(A) Hitler flouted the military clause in the Versailles Treaty and declared re-armament
(B) Hitler wanted to re-establish the lost power and glory of Germany

1.(B) contradicts (A)
2.(B) is the reason for (A)
3.(A) is true but (B) is false
4.(A) and (B) are independent of each other.

ATTACK ON PEARL HARBOUR

1. America followed a policy of strict neutrality. The American Congress decided to lend or lease armaments to Britain and China, because their defence was vital to the defence of the United States.

2. The only military force that Japan had to fear was the US Pacific Fleet based at Pearl Harbour in Hawaii.

3. On December 7, 1941, Japan under the Premiership of General Tojo, ordered a surprise aerial attack on the Pearl Harbour. The battleships were sunk and the important airfields were destroyed. 3700 people were killed.

ATTACK ON PEARL HARBOUR

1. The Japanese made two crucial mistakes at Pearl Harbour-they did not destroy the ship repair facilities at the base nor did they destroy the US carriers (Lexington and the Enterprise).

2. As a result, most of the ships, that were damaged, were soon back in action.

3. On December 8, 1941, the USA joined the War stopping the Japanese advance



BOMBING OF HIROSHIMA AND NAGASAKI

1. The Americans started their offensive against Japan to liberate the islands in the Southwest Pacific.
2. The American navy and air force destroyed the Japanese fleet, but Japan was still firmly and strongly established in China, Manchuria and other places.
3. In 1945, the Japanese in the Philippines formed a special force called the 'kamikaze' (the suicide air corps).
4. Young Japanese pilots steered an explosive-laden plane into the side or deck of an American ship. Civilians too had been trained in the use of a variety of weapons. This made a land invasion of Japan costly and useless.

BOMBING OF HIROSHIMA AND NAGASAKI

1. Long before the invasion on Japan was planned, scientists in United States were working on the most powerful weapon ever made- the atomic bomb.
2. In July 1945, the first atomic bomb was detonated (test) in the desert near Alamogordo, New Mexico.





1. After much debate, the decision to use the bomb was taken.

2. Days before the first bomb was dropped on Japan, American planes dropped leaflets warning about the deadly weapon and urging the Japanese people and government to end the fighting.

3. On August 6, 1945, the first atomic bomb ever to be used on humans, was dropped on Hiroshima.

4. It destroyed half of the city killing thousands of people. Despite the terrible destruction, the Japanese still refused to surrender.

5. On August 9, 1945, another bomb was dropped on Nagasaki. On September 2, 1945, Japan surrendered unconditionally. After six long years, World War II was over.

When was the first atomic bomb dropped and where?

1. August 6, 1947; Berlin
2. August 6, 1945; Hiroshima
3. August 8, 1945; Nagasaki
4. August 8, 1947, New Mexico

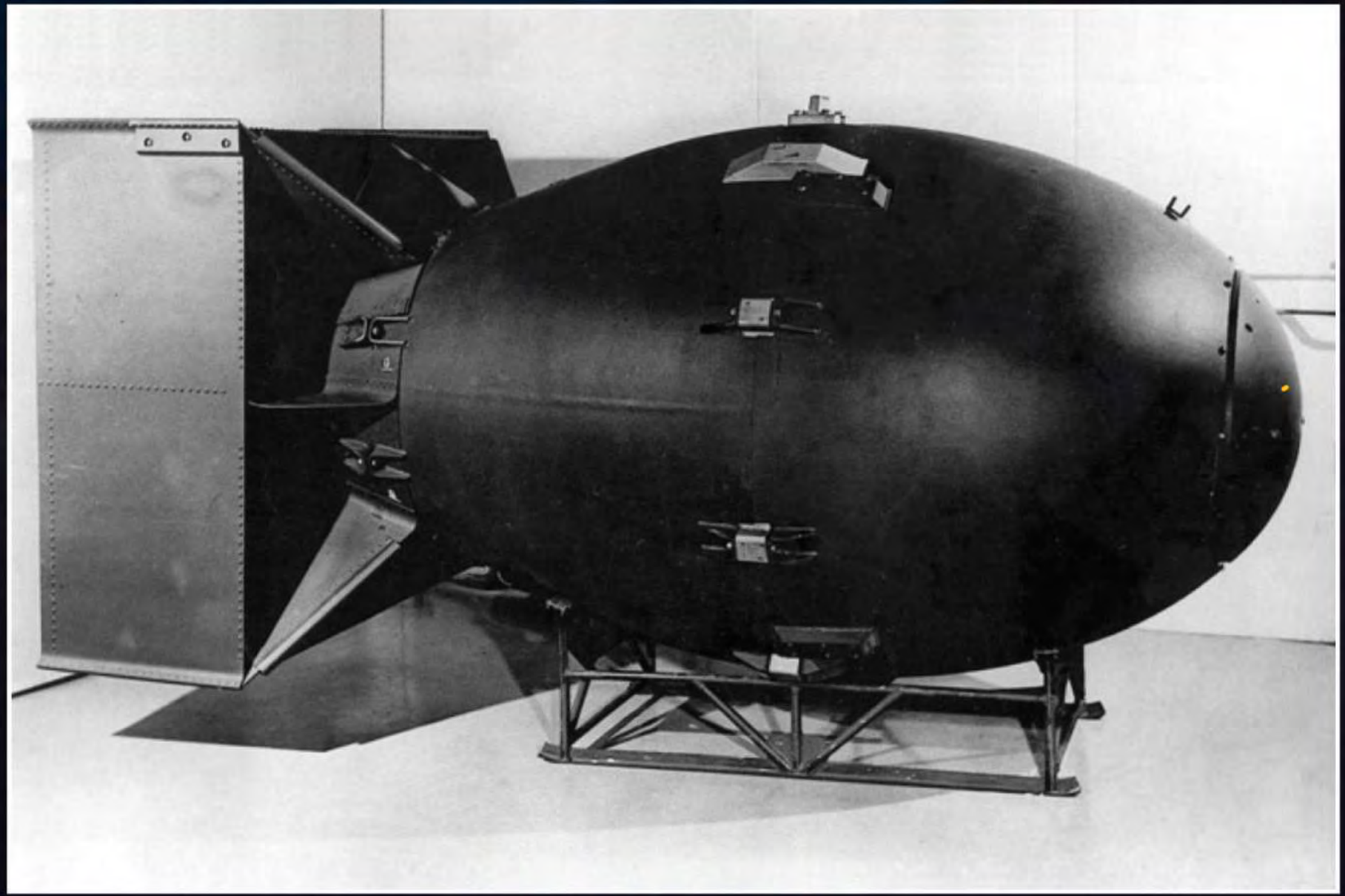
1. Over 50 million people perished in the Second World War. Of them about 22 million were soldiers and the rest civilians.

2. About 12 million people lost their lives in concentration camps or as a result of the terror unleashed by the fascists. Some countries lost a large percentage of their population.

3. For example, Poland lost six million people, about five million of them civilians; which was about 20 per cent of the Polish population. The Soviet Union lost about 20 million people which was about 10 per cent of the population.

1. The various nations who took part in the war spent most of their national wealth and suffered heavy losses.

2. The chief colonial powers lost their power and many countries like India, Myanmar and Sri Lanka became independent. Later other countries of Asia and Africa were liberated one by one from imperial control.



THE ATOM BOMB

CONSEQUENCES OF THE SECOND WORLD WAR

1. **Defeat of Axis Powers:** Up to the middle of 1942, the Axis powers (Germany, Italy and Japan) met with remarkable success and captured large territories in Europe, Africa and Asia.

- But by the end of 1942, the tide began to turn against the Axis Powers. In November 1942, the Allied forces (Britain, France, the Soviet Union and the USA) recaptured African territories lost by France.
- This was followed by their victory over Italy and then Germany.
- After the defeat of Germany, the Allied Powers turned their attention towards Japan, Japan had won and had occupied most of South East Asia.

CONSEQUENCES OF THE SECOND WORLD WAR

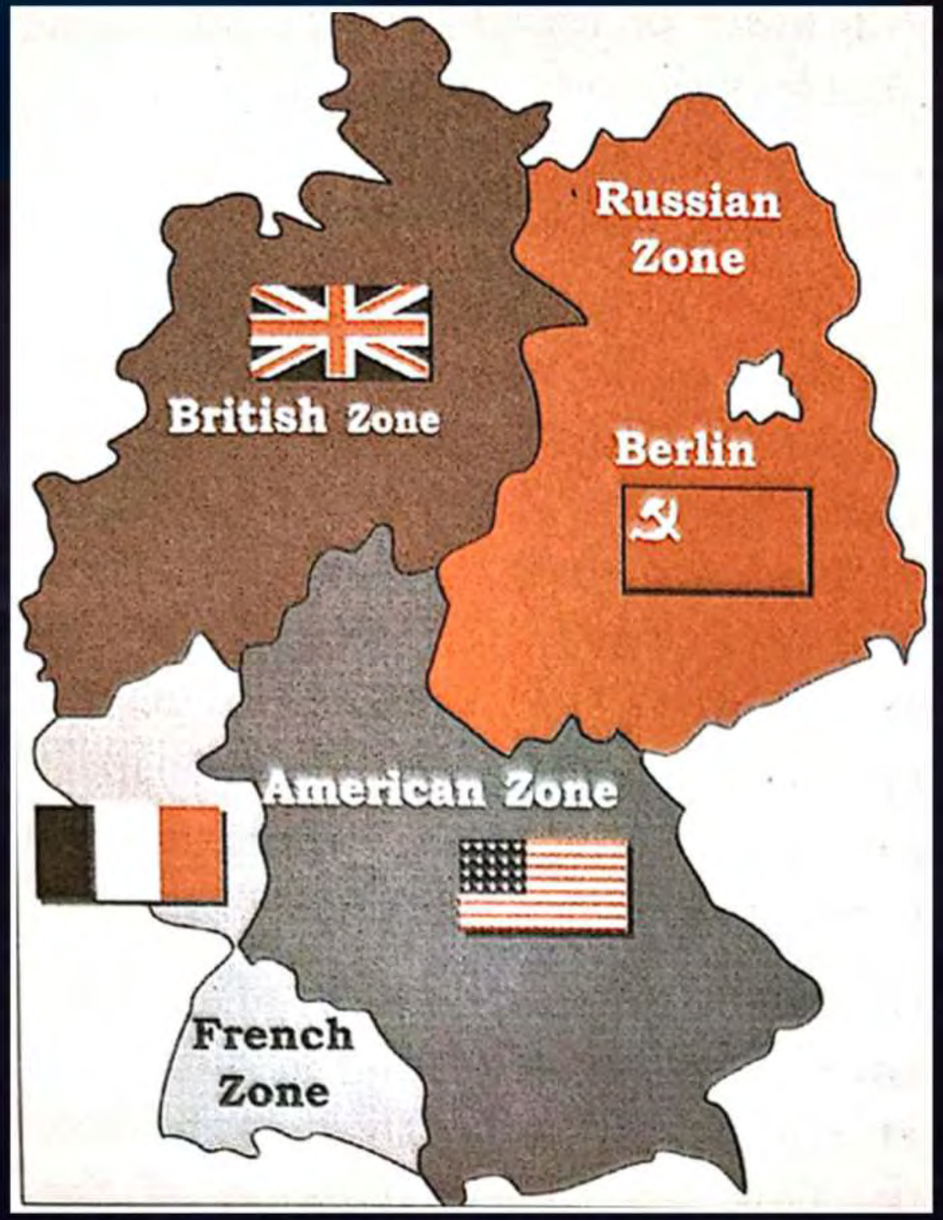
- The British forces liberated Myanmar, Malaya, Philippines and Singapore.
- In the Potsdam Conference held on July 26, 1945, the Allied Powers asked Japan to surrender, but Japan. refused.
- Consequently, America dropped the atomic bombs on Hiroshima and Nagasaki.
- Japan offered to surrender on the terms of Potsdam declaration and the war came to an end.

Thus, after the war, the Axis Powers had to face the following consequences:

(i) At the end of World War II, Germany was divided into zones, each zone under the army of each of the Allied Powers.

(a) The Federal Republic of Germany (FRG) commonly known as West Germany was administered by UK, France and the U.S. with Bonn as the capital. It came under the capitalist ideology of the Anglo- American and their Allies and became part of the Capitalist bloc.

(b) The German Democratic Republic (GDR), known as East Germany was administered by the Soviet Union with East Berlin as the capital. It came under the influence of the political ideologies of communist Russia and became part of the Communist (or Eastern) bloc.



DIVISION OF GERMANY

(ii) Japan and Italy also became very weak. Unlike Germany, they were not divided into zones to be governed by conquering forces.

- The American army occupied Japan until 1952.
- After this period, the Japanese would 'resume complete control over their own affairs.
- Emperor Hirohito was left on the throne as constitutional monarch and the Japanese Parliament retained some of its law-making powers.
- All lands acquired or seized by Japan since 1895 were taken away.



2. Formation of the UN:

1. The horrors of the two World Wars and the failure of the League of Nations led to a meeting of the Big Three- **Roosevelt (President of the USA), Churchill (Prime Minister of Britain) and Stalin (Premier of the USSR) at Yalta in February 1945.**

2. They decided to convene a conference of the representatives of all nations at San Francisco to draw up the 'Charter of the United Nations.'

3. This led to the establishment of the United Nations Organisation on October 24, 1945. We shall study this in detail in the next chapter.

3. Cold War:

1. During the Second World War, the USA and the Soviet Union fought together in cooperation with each other.

2. However, towards the end of the War, the apparent harmony between the USA and the Soviet Union declined and old suspicion and ideological differences came to the forefront.

3. Though both the countries did not engage in actual fight against each other, there was a state of extreme political tension between the two.

4. This state of tension between countries in which each side adopted policies designed to strengthen itself and weaken the other without armed conflict, is known as the 'Cold War.'

1. Cold War is defined as an atmosphere when there is no armed struggle, but the rivals continue to maintain their peace time diplomatic relations along with their hostility.

2. The Cold War also involved an arms race involving piling up of nuclear and conventional weapons, formation of military alliances, economic warfare and trade embargoes, propaganda and proxy wars, especially those involving superpower support for opposing sides within civil wars.

3. Thus, the USA and the USSR continued to maintain diplomatic relations and did clash, but treated each other with hostility.

4. This led to the division of the world into two power blocs. One bloc was led by the USA and the other by the erstwhile USSR.

(i) **The Democratic and Capitalist Bloc:** The bloc led by the USA, called the Western bloc or the American bloc believed in liberal democracy based on Capitalism.

- This bloc comprised Britain, France, Belgium, Italy, Canada, Australia, the Netherlands, Greece, Pakistan, Turkey, etc.

- They considered the political and social system of the USSR as objectionable and dangerous as it had no place for Parliamentary democracy and individual liberty.

- They projected the USSR as the enemy of world peace and Communism a grave threat to freedom and liberty throughout the world.

- America tried to maintain her influence by giving economic aid to different countries. The United States, as the leader of the Free World, took upon itself, the responsibility of preventing communism from spreading.

(ii) The Communist Bloc: The bloc led by the USSR, called the Eastern bloc or the Soviet bloc believed in Communism based on Marxist theory.

- The Soviet bloc countries considered the Western style democracy as a farce, meant only for the rich and upper middle class.
- Therefore, they wanted to spread Communism in the world and bring about a change in the social system of all the countries of the world.
- The USSR was determined to maintain political, economic and military control of the countries in eastern Europe which had been liberated from Nazi control.

- Thus, by 1948, governments which owed allegiance to Moscow were established in Poland, Hungary, Romania, Bulgaria and Czechoslovakia.
- Though Yugoslavia and Albania were not directly linked to Russia as satellites, the governments of these two countries were also Communist.
- Thus, the whole Europe was divided into two power blocs.

1. The two blocs openly propagated against each other and considered each problem from the point of view of the bloc and left no opportunity to weaken the opponent.

2. But at the same time, they made every effort to avoid a direct conflict.

Which of the following was NOT done during the Cold War?

1.Piling up of arms

2.Military alliances

3.Actual combat → (fight)

4.Proxy wars

According to the given news article , what is V-J Day and Why Did Japan Surrender to Allies ?

1.Victory over Japan
2.Atomic Bombing over Hiroshima and Nagasaki
3.V-J means Victim of Japan Bombings over Pearl Harbour
4.Both a and b

With reference to the newspaper headline given below, what is meant by V-J Day and what made Japan to surrender to the Allies.



"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times.

LATE CITY EDITION

Section 1

VOL. XCIV.No. 31,598. NEW YORK, SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 2, 1945.

JAPAN SURRENDERS TO ALLIES, SIGNS RIGID TERMS ON WARSHIP; TRUMAN SETS TODAY AS V-J DAY

HOLIDAY TRAFFIC NEAR 1941 LEVEL; 'GAS' IS PLENTIFUL

Exodus From City Is Greatest Since Pre-War Days but Congestion Is Avoided

GOOD WEATHER PROMISED

Near-by Resorts Do Capacity Business—3 Persons Die in Queens Accidents

Times Sq. Takes V-J News Quietly

HAILS ERA OF PEACE

President Calls On U.S. to Stride On Toward a World of Good-Will

SALUTES HEROIC DEAD

Cautions Jubilant Nation Hard Jobs Ahead Need Same Zeal as War

By WILLIAM S. WHITE

JAPANESE FOREIGN MINISTER SIGNING SURRENDER ARTICLES

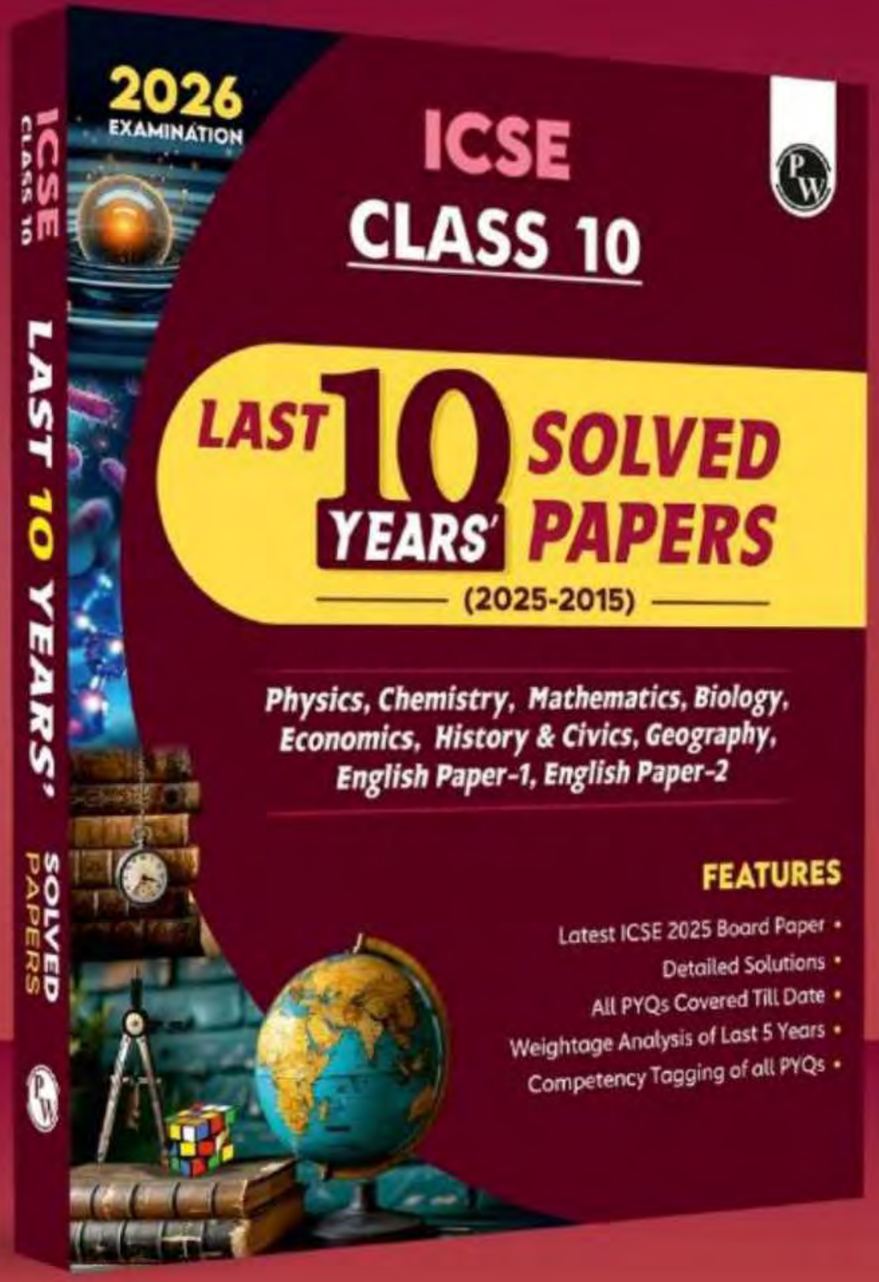
WAR COMES TO END

Articles of Capitulation Endorsed by Countries in Pacific Conflict

M'ARTHUR SEES PEACE

Emperor Orders Subjects to Obey All Commands Issued by General

PHYSICS WALLAH



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